Not Your Mom

A Reflective Companion for Intentional Social Media Use

What is Not Your Mom?

Not Your Mom is a reflective companion designed to introduce awareness at the exact moment of impulsive social media use.

No Lecturing

It doesn't tell you what to do. It just asks what's going on, leaving the choice entirely to you.

Preserving Autonomy

The core philosophy is to empower users to make conscious choices rather than being "parented" by an app.

The Entry Moment

NOT YOUR MOM OVERLAY

“Hey — you’re about to open Instagram. What’s going on right now?”

Not Your Mom appears instantly when you attempt to open the app, activating reflection before the habit loop completes. It’s a gentle nudge, not a lecture.

Emotional Understanding

Not Your Mom interprets your response to understand your current emotional context, ensuring the interaction feels personally attuned rather than formulaic.

Stress or Anxiety

Recognizes overwhelm. Prioritizes regulation and grounding without the "parental" pressure.

Low Mood

Identifies sadness. Focuses on warmth and human presence, not behavior correction.

Neutral or Calm

Detects casual use. Introduces light reflective redirects to keep you intentional.

Path A: Supporting Stressed Users

Emotional Regulation First

When Not Your Mom detects overwhelm, it prioritizes your emotional state over behavior redirection.

The goal is to provide a moment of calm, allowing you to transition from a reactive state to a more conscious one.

1. Grounding Action

Not Your Mom offers a brief grounding exercise, like slow breathing, before asking about app use.

2. Reflective Follow-up

After 15 minutes, Not Your Mom returns to ask if your original intention was fulfilled, helping you close the session.

Path B: Empathy for Low Mood

When you express sadness or low energy, Not Your Mom prioritizes emotional validation over behavior change.

Human Concern

Not Your Mom responds with warmth, focusing on emotional presence rather than habit interruption.

Supportive Connection

Gently encourages connection with real-world support if deeper distress is revealed.

"The priority is emotional validation rather than habit interruption."

Path C: Introducing Intentionality

For casual triggers like boredom or habit, Not Your Mom acknowledges the reason and offers a light reflective redirect.

Enter Normally

Proceed to Instagram as usual, with the awareness of your initial impulse.

Intentional Session

Articulate a specific goal. Not Your Mom allows entry and checks back after several minutes.

This path preserves flexibility while introducing a layer of conscious purpose.

Intentional Use Mode

Not Your Mom transforms open-ended scrolling into bounded, purposeful actions by requiring you to articulate your goals before entry.

01

Articulate Purpose

State a specific intention (e.g., "checking messages") before the session begins.

02

Bounded Session

Not Your Mom allows entry with the stated goal in mind, creating a mental boundary.

03

Completion Check

After 5-7 minutes, Not Your Mom returns to ask if the intended action was completed.

Session Closure Ritual

NOT YOUR MOM CLOSURE

"What drew you to Instagram, and did the experience provide what you needed?"

This brief reflection helps convert an unfinished impulse into a completed intention. By confirming if needs were met, Not Your Mom reinforces closure and reduces the likelihood of immediate reopening.

Managing Reentry and Friction

If you attempt to reopen Instagram shortly after a session, Not Your Mom introduces gentle friction to surface awareness of the recent behavior.

This friction is not a barrier, but a reflective pause that helps you recognize the strength of the habit loop in real-time.

"You always retain control. Not Your Mom never blocks access."

First Rapid Return

Not Your Mom asks whether you still want to go back, given you were just there.

Repeated Rapid Returns

Not Your Mom acknowledges the stronger pull and offers an optional short break.

Chronic Bypass

Patterns are noted for later reflection rather than immediate confrontation.

Breakup Mode: The Ultimate Agency

Not Your Mom recognizes that sometimes the healthiest choice isn't just "intentional use," but a complete departure from the platform.

Breakup Mode facilitates a conscious evaluation of your relationship with the app, identifying when it no longer serves your well-being.

"The most honest reflective boundary is the one that allows you to leave."

Conscious Exit

Relationship Evaluation

Not Your Mom asks: "Is this relationship still serving you?" after repeated negative reflections.

Supported Uninstallation

If you decide to "break up," Not Your Mom provides a guided path to uninstall the app.

Final Goodbye

A closing ritual that honors your decision to prioritize your mental space.

Core Outcomes

User Agency: You always retain full control and autonomy.

Human Connection: Interruption feels conversational, not mechanical.

Emotional Priority: Your internal state is acknowledged before behavior.

Intentionality: Social media use becomes bounded and purposeful.

Conscious Closure: Sessions end with reflection and ritual.

Not Your Mom: A reflective boundary around impulsive behavior.